



# The Shared Meal Introduction

## Today's goal

See how meals define community. Use Berger's ideas to read images of ritual, home, and public life.

## We are looking at

1. Leonardo da Vinci, The Last Supper (1495–1498)
2. Pieter Bruegel the Elder, The Peasant Wedding (1567)
3. Jean-François de Troy, Luncheon with Oysters (1735)
4. Jan Steen, The Merry Family (1668)
5. William Hogarth, Marriage à-la-mode: The Tête à Tête (1743)
6. Zhang Zeduan, Along the River During the Qingming Festival (12th c.)

## Key ideas from John Berger

- "The sharing of bread was once a pledge that all would live."
  - "To eat together is to affirm the common necessity of life."
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## Lesson map

### 1) Introduction: The Ethics of Sharing Food

- **Question:** What does sharing food represent?
- **Goal:** Introduce food as a moral act that builds community.
- **Link to Berger:** "The sharing of bread was once a pledge that all would live."

## 2) Sacred Meals and Rituals

- **Artworks:** *The Last Supper* (Leonardo), *Supper at Emmaus* (Caravaggio)
- **Question:** How do sacred meals use food to convey divine order or moral responsibility?

## 3) The Domestic Meal: Community and Care

- **Artworks:** *The Peasant Wedding* (Bruegel), *Luncheon with Oysters* (de Troy).
- **Question:** How do domestic meals reveal values of family and class?

## 4) Critiquing Excess and Decay

- **Artworks:** *The Merry Family* (Steen), *Marriage à-la-mode* (Hogarth).
- **Question:** What happens when food becomes a symbol of excess or moral decay?

## 5) Public Meals and Shared Society

- **Artwork:** *Along the River During the Qingming Festival* (Zhang Zeduan).
- **Question:** How do public meals reflect social order and shared culture?

## 6) Conclusion: What Makes a "Good" Shared Meal?

- **Key Question:** What do these works suggest about the ethics of shared meals?

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## Vocabulary

Perspective, gesture, ritual, procession, still life, satire, etiquette, civics, labor, abundance, scarcity.

## Exit note

Write one sentence answering: What does a good table require?

## Related Excerpts

Zhang Zeduan, Along the River During the Qingming Festival

Marriage a la Mode Story